NANYANG JUNIOR COLLEGE
Year 2 Preliminary Examination

H2 GEOGRAPHY 9173/01

Paper 1 15 Sept 2026

INSERT

3 hours

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Insert contains all the Resources referred to in the questions.

Resource 1 for Question 1

Educational Infrastructure Disparities in ASEAN

Photograph A: Digital Classroom in an Urban Primary School (Bangkok, Thailand)



Source: https://www.bangkokpost.com/opinion/opinion/3199658/critical-thinking-skills-under-ai-pressure

Photograph B: A state primary school classroom in Vientiane, Laos



Source: https://www.thestar.com.my/aseanplus/aseanplus-news/2024/07/15/laos-education-dept-says-spiralling-rate-of-school-dropout-rate-in-country-due-to-poor-teaching-qualities

Resource 2 for Question 1

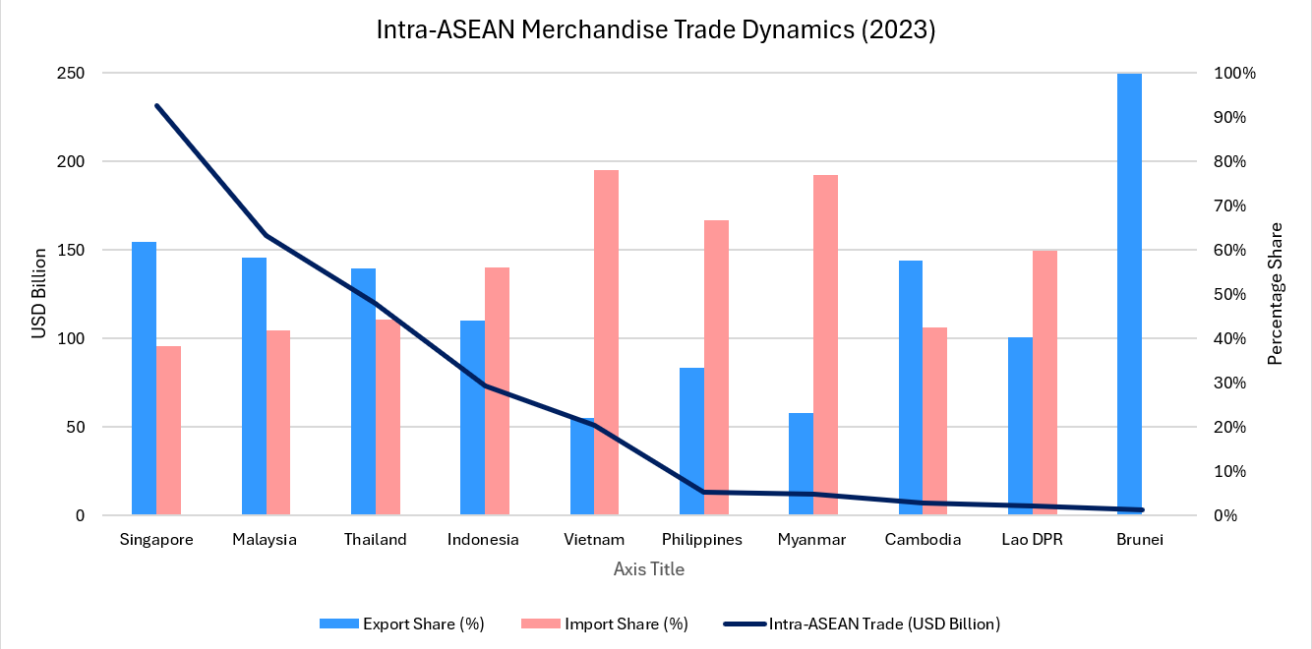
Employment Share by Sector in Selected ASEAN Economies (in 1990 and 2022)

Country & Year	Primary (Agriculture) %	Secondary (Industry) %	Tertiary (Services) %
Singapore (1990)	0.40%	35.20%	64.40%
Singapore (2022)	0.10%	14.80%	85.10%
Vietnam (1990)	71.30%	12.10%	16.60%
Vietnam (2022)	27.50%	33.40%	39.10%
Lao DPR (1990)	82%	4.50%	13.50%
Lao DPR (2022)	58.20%	11.60%	30.20%

Source: World Bank Open Data - Employment by Sector in East Asia & Pacific & ILOSTAT International Labour Organization Database

Resource 3 for Question 1

The intra-ASEAN trade flows (in USD billions) alongside export and import shares



Source: ASEANstats - ASEAN Secretariat Trade Dynamics Report

[Turn over

Resource 4 for Question 1

Excerpt of a News Article on Poverty Reduction and Social Disparities in ASEAN

Bridging Southeast Asia's Growth Divide: Progress and Persistent Poverty Gaps
JAKARTA — November 14, 2023

Over the past three decades, Southeast Asia has achieved rapid poverty reduction, driven by robust industrial growth and expanding trade integration. According to joint regional assessments by the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), national poverty rates across the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) have dropped significantly. High-growth industrial hubs and capital regions—such as the Metro Manila area, Greater Jakarta, and the Bangkok Metropolitan Region—have seen poverty levels fall below 3%.

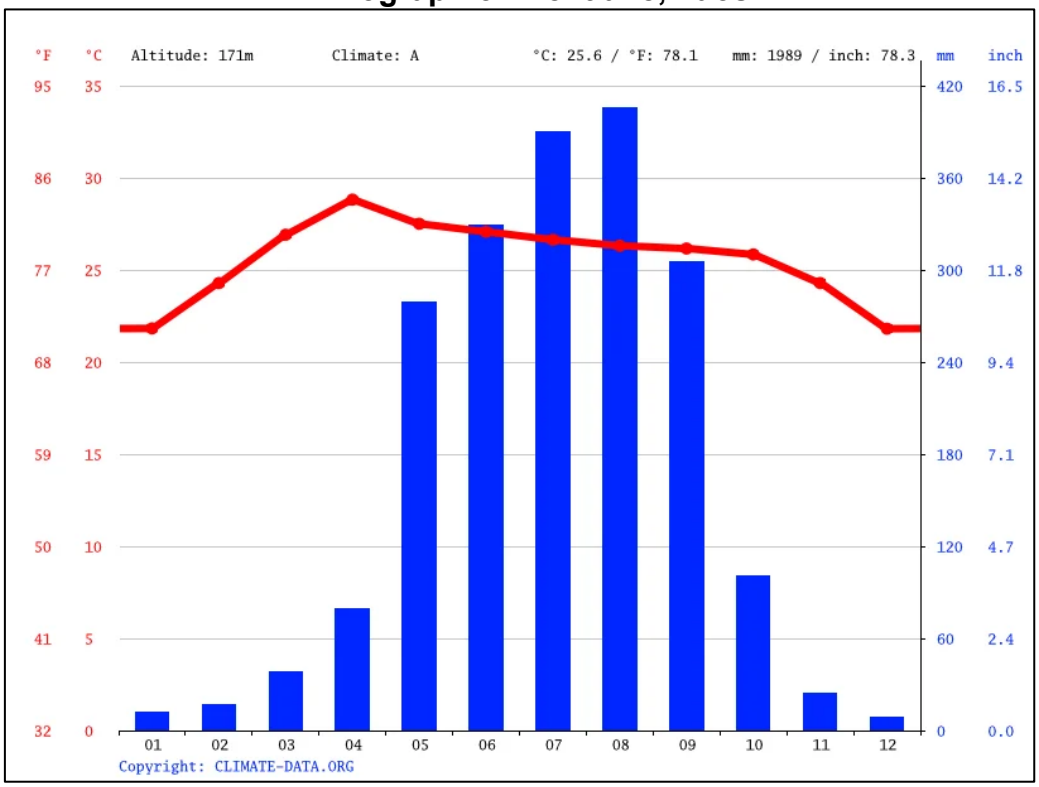
However, regional analysts emphasize that aggregate national figures conceal severe spatial disparities within individual member countries and between regional sub-tier economies. While urban centers thrive on capital investments and service-sector jobs, rural peripheries remain isolated. In Thailand's rural Northeastern region (Isan), poverty rates linger at 12.4%, compared to just 1.1% in Bangkok. Similarly, in agrarian-dependent lower-income economies like Lao PDR and Myanmar, rural poverty exceeds 25%, exacerbated by limited social protection systems, lower adult literacy levels, and poor transportation infrastructure.

Development economists stress that while economic expansion has uplifted millions, unequal access to quality education, modern infrastructure, and capital investments risks creating persistent pockets of spatial poverty across ASEAN.

Source: Asian Development Bank Development Features - Poverty Reduction and Inclusive Growth in Southeast Asia & UNDP Localizing SDGs in ASEAN

Resource 5 for Question 2

Climograph of Vientiane, Laos



Source: https://en.climate-data.org/asia/laos/vientiane-capital/vientiane-1323/

Resource 6 for Question 2

Satellite map of the Mekong River between Laos and Thailand (upper course of the Mekong River).

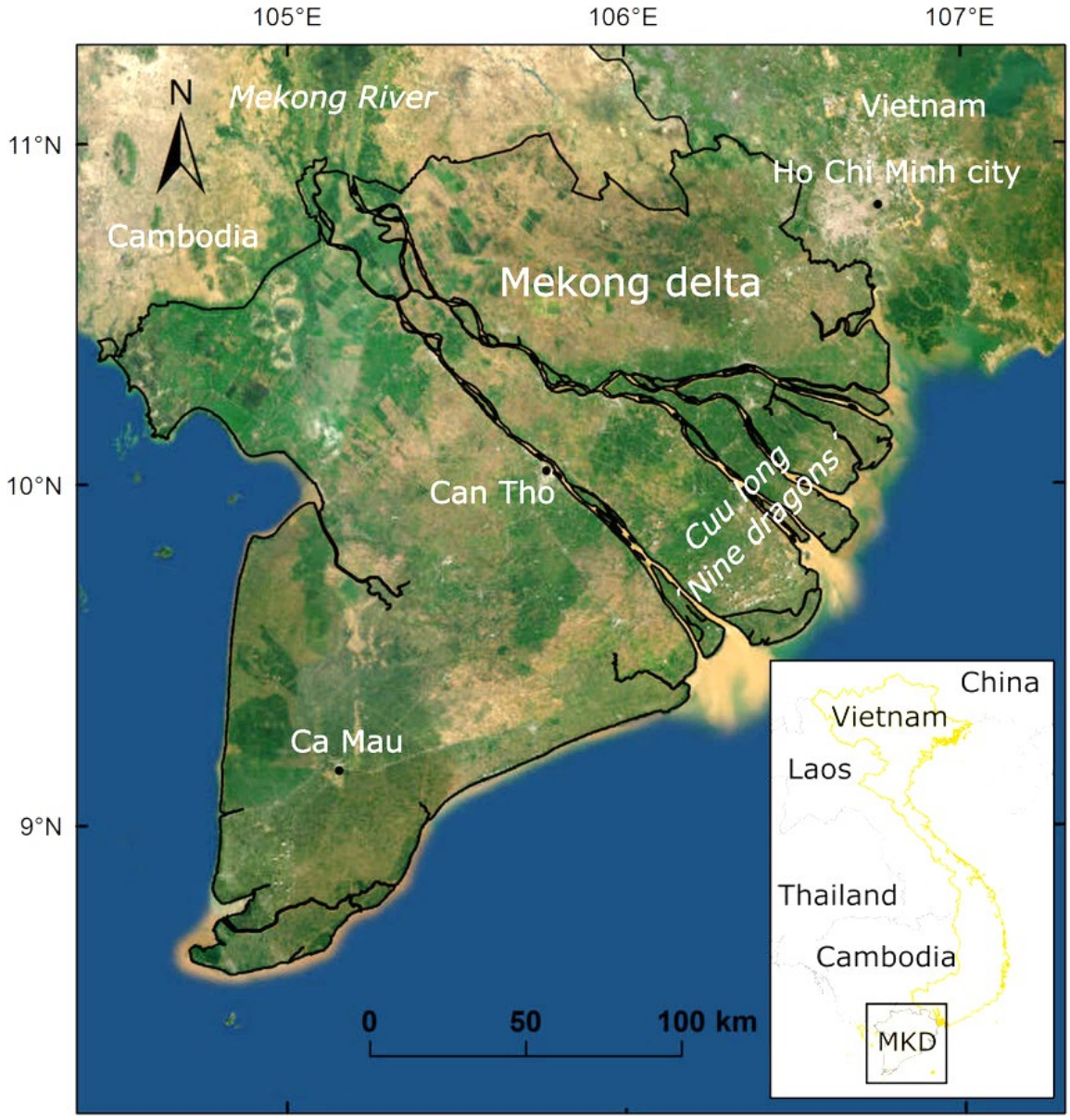


Source:https://gemini.google.com/app/a2edef8ee614c9b7?utm_source=deepmind.google&utm_medium=referral&utm_campaign=gdm&utm_content=

[Turn over

Resource 7 for Question 2

The Mekong Delta in Vietnam



Source: https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Location-of-the-Vietnamese-Mekong-delta-in-South-East-Asia-Source-satellite-imagery_fig1_344238481

Resource 8 for Question 2
Excerpts from articles on the state of the Mekong River Basin

In the past, about 160 million metric tons of sediment was annually funneled down the 4,300-kilometer (nearly 2,700-mile) Mekong River to form and nourish the vast delta where the river meets the sea. By 2024, that deposition rate had fallen by 70% per year — starving the delta of much of its source material.

Deltas like the Mekong are subject to a "double burden" of rapidly rising sea levels due to climate change, along with sinking land — subsidence driven by local processes including aquifer pumping for drinking water and agriculture, along with impacts from upstream dams that greatly reduce water and sediment flows.

More than half the sediment that once reached the delta is now trapped in reservoirs behind dams. Currently, 745 dams are complete or under construction on the Mekong mainstream and its basin tributaries. Existing and proposed dams (if all completed) could trap up to 96% of the sediment that historically nourished the delta.

In rapidly industrialising and urbanising Southeast Asia, demand for sand for use in construction and as landfill is high and increasing. Sand is mined throughout the lower Mekong basin but is most intensively extracted in Cambodia and Vietnam. A 2022 study of sand mining in Vietnam's Mekong Delta estimated that an average of 43 million cubic metres was extracted annually between 2015 and 2020.

On the Mekong Delta, life has become more precarious. Floods now last far longer, with higher water levels than before, with muddy water frequently pushing into people's homes, and even beds, and disrupting daily life.

Adapted from:
https://news.mongabay.com/2026/05/the-worlds-great-deltas-are-sinking-and-with-them-a-global-food-system/
and https://www.crisisgroup.org/rpt/asia/south-east-asia/cambodia-thailand-china/343-dammed-mekong-averting-environmental-catastrophe

End of Paper